

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Chronology, geography and evidence

3rd millennium BCE -> Harappan-West Asian commercial contact

3rd c. BCE setting -> Sri Lankan mission memory develops in later chronicles

EARLY CE -> Central Asian, Chinese and Southeast Asian links widen

3rd-6th c. CE -> Buddhist and Shaiva networks visible across several regions

7th c. onward -> Srivijaya and major trans-Asian monastic circuits

SOURCES -> inscriptions + texts + pilgrims + ports + monuments + objects

RULE: region-specific dates outrank one diffusion timeline.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: From Greater India to connected histories

OLDER MODEL -> Indianization / Greater India

USEFUL OBSERVATION -> real movement of scripts, religions and political idioms

CORE PROBLEM -> passive recipients + cultural ownership + empire-like language

CONNECTED MODEL:

- |-- transmission through routes and carriers

- |-- local selection and translation

- |-- hybrid form and new political meaning

- `-- return flows to Indian institutions

VERDICT: influence and Asian agency belong in the same sentence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Route ecology

NORTH-WEST -> Gandhara -> Bactria -> oasis Silk Roads -> China

HIMALAYAN -> Kashmir / Nepal -> Tibet

BAY OF BENGAL -> east-coast ports -> Sri Lanka / Myanmar / Malay world

STRAITS -> Kedah / Srivijaya -> Java / South China Sea

ARABIAN SEA -> west-coast links and wider exchange

MECHANISM -> monsoon timing + ports + hinterlands + intermediaries

LIMIT: a route or port does not prove political control.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Carriers and media

PEOPLE -> merchants + monks + translators + diplomats + artisans

TEXTS -> sutras + chronicles + epics + legal and political vocabulary

OBJECTS -> relics + icons + manuscripts + coins + ritual goods

INSTITUTIONS -> monasteries + courts + ports + guilds + translation bureaux

POWER -> local rulers select portable idioms for local legitimacy

RETURN -> pilgrims, gifts and overseas endowments reshape Indian centres

RULE: identify carrier + route + institution + adapted outcome.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Gandhara, Central Asia and China

INDIA <-> GANDHARA HYBRID ZONE <-> CENTRAL ASIAN OASES <-> CHINA

KUSHANA NETWORKS -> political and commercial connectivity

MONKS / MANUSCRIPTS -> Buddhist transmission across changing routes

TRANSLATION INSTITUTIONS -> Chinese conceptual remaking, not word substitution

FAXIAN / XUANZANG / YIJING -> journeys into India and evidence carried back

ART -> shared vocabulary changes by material, patron and region

VERDICT: transmission repeatedly created new local Buddhist worlds.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Tibet and Sri Lanka

TIBET

Himalayan routes

translation projects

Indian teachers and texts

monastic institutionalisation

local doctrinal development

COMMON RULE: reception transformed what was received

SOURCE CAUTION: chronicle memory is not the same as contemporary inscription.

SRI LANKA

maritime and short-sea routes

Pali textual preservation

Mahavamsa mission tradition

relic, monastery and kingship links

Theravada consolidation and return influence

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Southeast Asian localisation

MYANMAR -> Pyu and later Buddhist networks

MAINLAND -> Dvaravati + Funan/Chenla + Champa + Khmer worlds

ISLAND -> Java + Sumatra + straits-centred Srivijaya

RELIGION -> Buddhist + Shaiva + Vaishnava idioms in different combinations

MONUMENTS -> Borobudur + Angkor + My Son; local plans and political meanings

POLITY -> Sanskrit titles and ritual adapted by Asian courts

LIMIT: shared vocabulary is not a map of Indian colonies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Scripts, Sanskrit and local languages

INDIC SCRIPT / LANGUAGE MODEL

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local scribes select signs, terms and formulae

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phonology + grammar + political needs reshape the model

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new regional inscriptions and literary cultures

SANSKRIT -> portable prestige idiom, not proof of ethnic replacement

VERNACULARS -> active partners in localisation and court communication.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Religion, epics and performance

BUDDHISM -> relics + sangha + pilgrimage + translation

SHAIVA / VAISHNAVA -> temples + ritual specialists + royal legitimation

RAMAYANA / MAHABHARATA -> retelling in local languages and performance forms

LOCAL CULTS -> absorb, redirect and coexist with imported idioms

EPIC VARIANTS -> evidence of creative adaptation, not textual corruption

PLURALITY -> different traditions travel through overlapping networks

VERDICT: transmission succeeded through translation into local worlds.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Art and architecture: shared form, local work

GANDHARA -> hybrid frontier art, not merely Greek art abroad

BAMIYAN -> Central Asian Buddhist landscape and monumental scale

BOROBUDUR -> Javanese Buddhist monument with local spatial logic

ANGKOR -> Khmer political-sacred landscape

MY SON -> Cham Shaiva architecture and regional technique

METHOD -> form + material + patron + ritual + local environment

TRAP: resemblance alone cannot establish date, route or political domination.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Trade, political idioms and reciprocity

GOODS + SHIPPING + PORT-HINTERLAND NETWORKS

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merchants, guilds, monasteries and courts meet

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titles + scripts + rituals + images gain political value

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local rulers recast them for regional sovereignty

RETURN FLOW -> pilgrims + Pali preservation + overseas gifts to Nalanda

LIMIT: commerce enables contact but does not mechanically cause cultural change.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Connected-history answer spine

OPEN -> multi-directional interaction across land and sea

FRAME -> influence + localisation + reciprocity

MECHANISM -> route + carrier + institution

CASES -> Gandhara/China + Sri Lanka/Tibet + Southeast Asia

MATERIAL -> text + script + relic + monument + trade good

LIMIT -> uneven archives; no automatic conquest or ownership claim

CLOSE -> a connected Asian world that retained regional diversity.